

Setareh Seraj

Ph.D. Candidate in Computer Information Systems

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Zicklin School of Business, Baruch College, City University of New York

Education

Ph.D. in Computer Information Systems

2021–2027 (*expected*)

Zicklin School of Business, Baruch College, CUNY, New York, NY

- **Dissertation:** “Screens, Stress, and Careers: How Economic and Technological Forces Shape Digital Behavior and Job Outcomes”
- **Committee:** Dr. Shuting (Ada) Wang (Chair), Dr. Chengxin Cao, Dr. Radhika Jain
- Expected proposal defense: Fall 2026; expected graduation: June 2027

M.S. in Management Science and Technology

2019–2021

Amirkabir University of Technology (Tehran Polytechnic), Tehran, Iran

B.S. in Civil Engineering

2013–2017

Amirkabir University of Technology (Tehran Polytechnic), Tehran, Iran

Relevant Coursework (all degrees): Advanced Quantitative Methods, Multivariate Statistics, Econometrics, Applied Analytical Research, Information Economics, Linear Algebra, Numerical Analysis, Differential Equations, Dynamics, Systems Engineering

Research Interests

Labor Markets and IT, Social Impacts of IS, Economics of IS, Digital Platforms, Causal Inference

Methodologies: Econometric Modeling, Sentiment Analysis, Text Mining, Field Experiments

Teaching Interests

Data Analytics, Econometrics, Programming, Statistics, AI, Core IS courses

Publications

Under Review / Working Papers

Seraj, S., Wang, S., Cao, C., & Luo, Y. When universities go online: Employment consequences of IT master’s program adoption for bachelor’s graduates. *In preparation for submission to MIS Quarterly.*

Seraj, S. Economic volatility and the dynamics of online reading behavior. *Under review at Internet Research.*

Seraj, S. An empirical investigation of green brand reputation using social media. *Under review at Information Systems Education Journal.*

Published

Seraj, S., Nikravan, M., Ramezaniapour, A. A., & Zendehtdel, P. (2020). Evaluation of the application of municipal solid waste incinerator (MSWI) ash in civil engineering using a sustainability approach. *Detritus*, 9(March), 113–124.

Conference Presentations

Seraj, S., & Lahabi, S. (November 2026). Teaching case auditing AI: Using Excel to detect bias in a hiring system. *ISCAP Conference*, Asheville, NC.

- Seraj, S. (December 2025). Economic volatility and the dynamics of online reading behavior. *Workshop on Information Systems and Economics (WISE)*, Nashville, TN.
- Seraj, S. (October 2025). Toxic pressure or therapeutic escape? Financial stress and the dynamics of online reading behavior. *Conference on Information Systems and Technology (CIST)*, Atlanta, GA.
- Seraj, S. (2017). Evaluation of the application of MSWI ash in civil engineering. *16th International Waste Management and Landfill Symposium*, Sardinia, Italy.

Teaching Experience

Adjunct Lecturer, Baruch College, CUNY (*~1,400 students*) *Jan 2022–Present*

CIS 2200 — Introduction to Information Systems

Total sections: 7 Total students: ~450

Topics: Core IS concepts, advanced Excel & VBA.

Original AI module (designed and implemented): team-based Excel audit of an AI hiring algorithm for bias and disparate impact.

Avg. teaching evaluation¹: 4.0 / 5.0

BUS 2000 — Business Fundamentals

Total sections: 43 Total students: ~950

Topics: Business ethics, research methods, applied case analysis project

Avg. teaching evaluation¹: 4.2 / 5.0

¹ Average of all evaluations from the most recent academic year.

Teaching Fellow, Baruch College, CUNY

Jan 2026–Present

ECO 1002 — Macroeconomics

Contributed to the redesign of introductory macroeconomics into a hybrid, workshop-based course combining short asynchronous video modules, repeated low-stakes quizzes, and paper-based in-class problem workshops.

CyberFellows Online Learning Program, Baruch College, CUNY

Fall 2025

Technical and instructional support for self-paced online modules (Excel, business software) in multiple asynchronous courses.

Awards & Grants

Zicklin School of Business Dean's Teaching Award *2026*

Banerjee Babu Award, Baruch College, CUNY *2026*

Doctoral Student Research Grant (DSRG), Round 20, Baruch College, CUNY *2025*

Donald Vredenburg Research Grant (DVRG), Baruch College, CUNY *2024*

Ph.D. Fellowship, Baruch College, CUNY *2021*

National Master's Entrance Exam: Ranked 88th of 30,000 participants (top 0.3%), Iran *2019*

National Undergraduate Entrance Exam: Ranked 664th of 250,000+ participants (top 0.3%), Iran *2013*

Service

Americas Region Coordinator, AIS Doctoral Student College, Association for Information Systems *2026*

Ad Hoc Reviewer: ICIS, HICSS, AMCIS *2025–2026*

Student Representative, BUS Ph.D. Program — CUNY Graduate Council Executive & Standing Committees *2025*

Professional Experience

Applied Research and Consulting Projects

Affluent Banking Strategy — Aviense Management Consulting, Tehran, Iran *Jan–Jul 2021*
Analyzed historical client performance data to identify segment-level trends, supporting a banking strategy engagement for a major financial institution.

India Market Entry Study — Datis Elevator Co., Tehran, Iran *Jan–Dec 2020*
Designed and executed a market entry analysis of India’s elevator industry, covering competitive landscape and demand assessment for an internationalization decision.

Platform User Acquisition Experiments — Bookapo, Tehran, Iran *Jan 2018–Dec 2019*
Designed and analyzed A/B tests on a newly launched book summary platform, examining acquisition and engagement outcomes through platform and Google Analytics data.

Other Research Experience

Research Assistant, Structural Xploration Lab, EPFL, Lausanne, Switzerland *Fall 2017*
Conducted a systematic literature review on construction and demolition waste supporting a life-cycle assessment of reused structural components.

Technical Skills

<i>Statistical Software</i>	Stata, R, SPSS
<i>Programming & Tools</i>	Python, SQL, MATLAB, L ^A T _E X, Git
<i>Econometric Methods</i>	Panel data analysis, difference-in-differences, event studies, propensity score matching, instrumental variables, causal inference
<i>Experimental Methods</i>	Experimental design, A/B testing, randomized field experiments
<i>AI & Machine Learning</i>	Natural language processing, predictive modeling, prompt engineering, LLM-based experimental design

References

Shuting (Ada) Wang (Chair)
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Chengxin Cao
Assistant Professor
Baruch College, CUNY
chengxin.cao@baruch.cuny.edu

Karl R. Lang
Professor
Baruch College, CUNY
karl.lang@baruch.cuny.edu

Hobbies

Kundalini yoga & meditation, contemplative philosophy reading, event planning, dancing, arts and crafts, tennis *Last updated: August 2026*